

Ali Iranmanesh

✉ afi5220@psu.edu in AliIranmanesh 🔗 AliIranmanesh 🎓 AliIranmanesh

Education

The Pennsylvania State University, Schreyer Honors College

B.S. in Computer Science

2024 – 2027 (Expected)

GPA: 4.00/4.00

Research Interests

AI Safety & Security Embodied AI Security Adversarial Robustness
Systems Security

Publications

HEARSAYBENCH: Can LLMs Navigate from Abstract Human Rights to Lived Lives?

Ali Iranmanesh*, Ava Iranmanesh*, Sobhan Lotfi*, Liwei Jiang

submitted to NeurIPS 2026

Not What You Asked For: Typographic Attacks in Household Robot Manipulation

Ali Iranmanesh, Peng Liu

submitting to USENIX Security 2027

Experience

Research Assistant

UCLA, supervised by Yuan Tian

United States, Los Angeles

Jul. 2026 – Present

- Researching VLA robustness, investigating adversarial attacks against the vision side of VLAs, targeting the binding stage where the model decides which object in the scene the words in the instruction refer to.

Research Assistant

University of Washington, supervised by Liwei Jiang

United States, Seattle

Jan. 2026 – May. 2026

- researching LLM safety and alignment, developing novel evaluation frameworks to benchmark LLM behavior in real-world contexts, and uncovering systematic risks faced by underrepresented groups when relying on LLMs for advice

Research Assistant

Penn State University, supervised by Peng Liu

United States, State College

Aug. 2025 – Present

- researching AI security and robustness of embodied AI systems, investigating typographic attacks against vision-language models in household manipulation robots and uncovering how physical-world text perturbations can jailbreak manipulation robots
- Investigating low-level systems security vulnerabilities in resource-constrained environments, specifically uncovering pointer alignment issues in Rust packages that can cause program crashes in embedded and constrained systems that depend on them

Co-Founder

Perkie

United States, State College

Nov. 2025 – Present

- A fintech application built with Flutter that uses LLMs for natural language processing to optimize credit card rewards; automatically scrapes and maintains an up-to-date database of card offers, querying cached results when available and triggering live scraping when new cards or deals are detected

Exchange Undergraduate Researcher

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Hong Kong SAR

Jun. 2024 – Aug. 2024

- Researched performance optimization of Database Management Systems on GPUs, focusing on advanced querying algorithms for accelerated workloads

Honors & Awards

B.&L. Gall Open Doors, Whitney Open Doors Honors, Chancellor's Scholarship

Penn State University

2026

- Scholarships awarded to Schreyer Scholars demonstrating exceptional academic and leadership achievement, providing **full-cost support** for undergraduate study

Gold Medal

Iran, Tehran

2020

- The Persian Young Physicists' Tournament, National Team qualification phase for Physics World Cup (IYPT)

Erickson Discovery Grant

Penn State University

2026

- Penn State grant awarded to support independent undergraduate research under faculty mentorship; awarded to only 10 students university-wide

Evan Pugh Award

Penn State University

2026

- Award presented to Juniors and Seniors undergraduate students who were in the top 0.5 percent of their classes

President Walker Award

Penn State University

2025

- Award presented to undergraduate students who have gained 4.0 GPA in their first year of study at Penn State

Projects

HomeBase

HomeBase

- An LLM-powered scheduling and payroll platform with an integrated chat system

Fidibook

Kindle-Project, Kindle-Project-Server

- A cross-platform mobile e-reader and audiobook player using Flutter and Java

Service & Leadership

Reviewer, ICML 2026

2026

- Reviewed research submissions on LLM evaluation and AI safety for a top-tier machine learning venue

Teaching Assistant, Penn State University

2025-present

- Teaching Assistant for Data Structures and Algorithms, Computer Organization and Architecture
- Peer Tutor for 100, 200, 300, 400 Level CMPSC and MATH Courses

Resident Assistant, Residence Life

2025-present

- Managed residential communities, enforced university policies, and supported student success and well-being

Vice President, Multi-Cultural Council

2025-2026

- Led council operations, coordinated campus-wide diversity initiatives, and advocated for inclusive programming across student organizations

President, Cybersecurity Society

2024-2025

- Led campus-wide cybersecurity initiatives, technical workshops, and competitive hacking teams